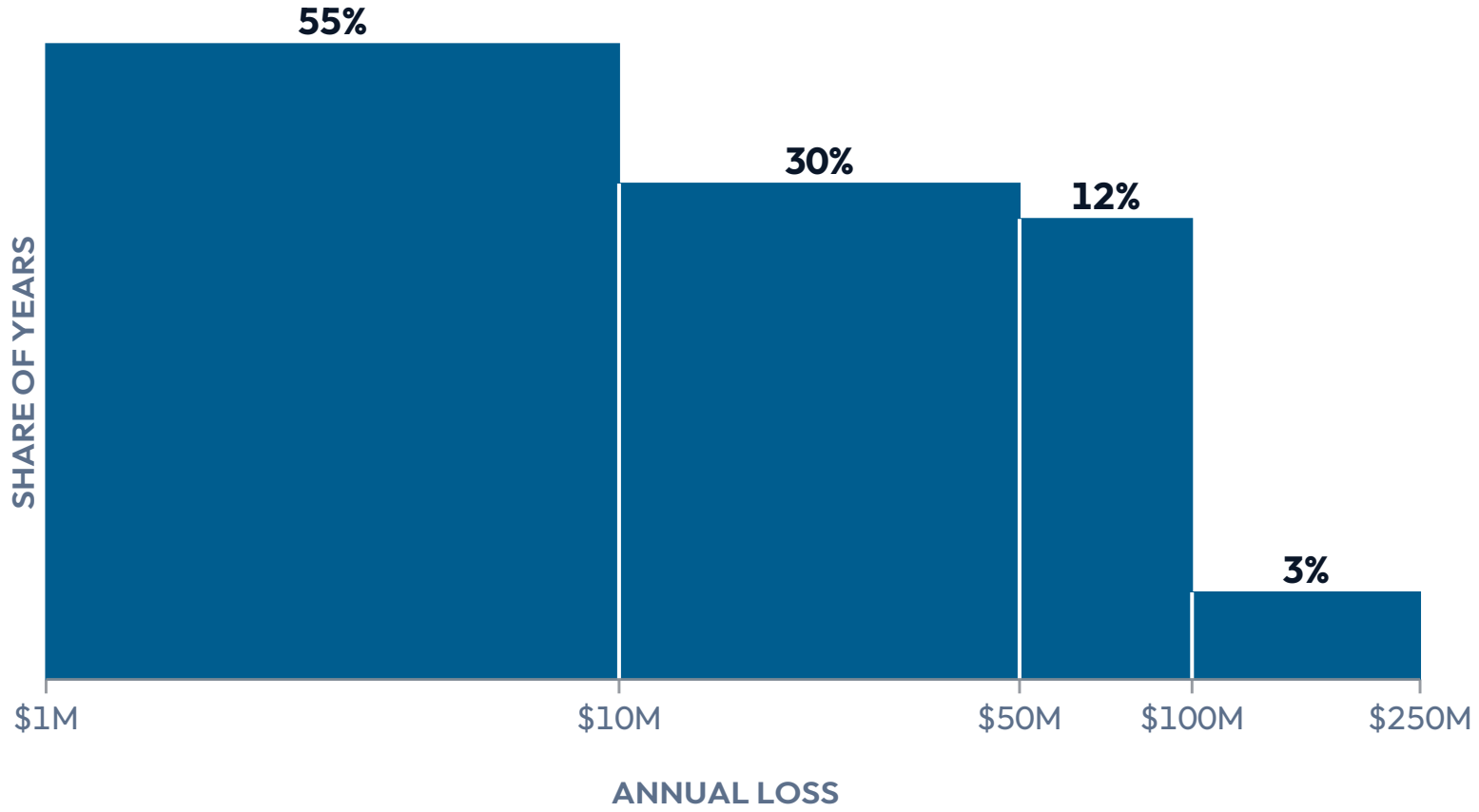
Evidence · Canvas · Series

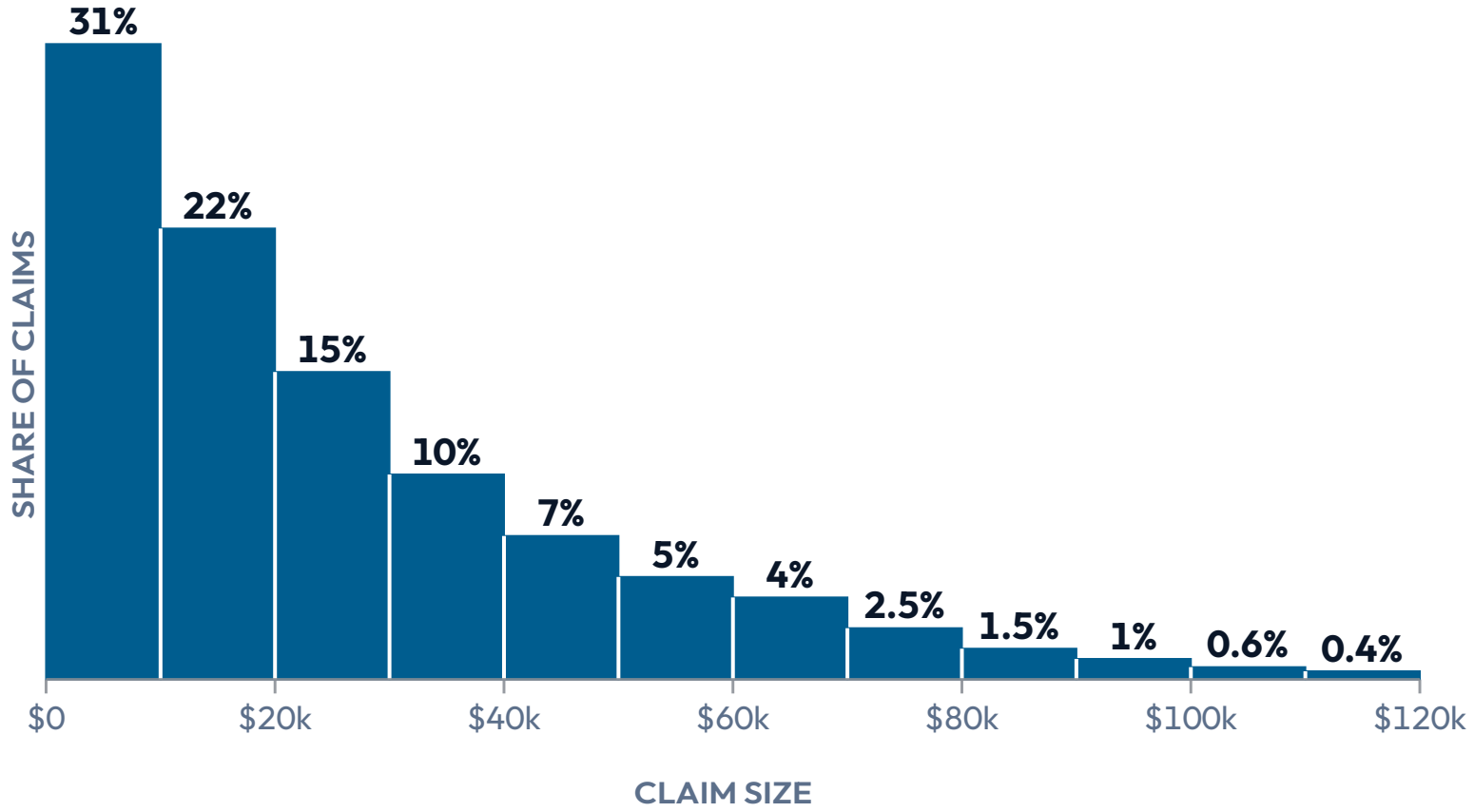
histogram

One quantity cut into bands that join end to end: each bar is as wide as its band and its area is the band's share, with an optional log axis for bands that widen toward the tail.

Most years stay under $10M; one in thirty tops $100M.

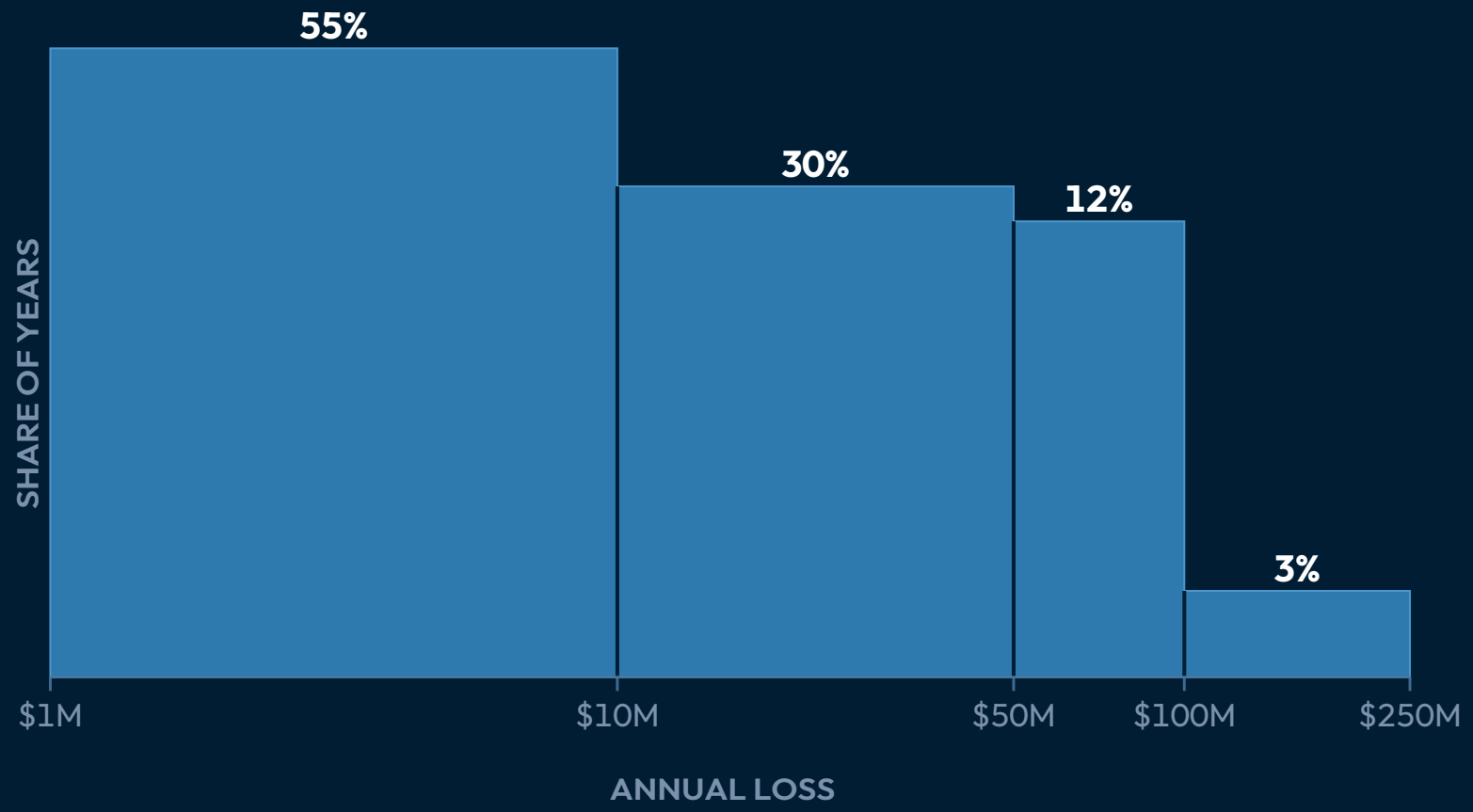


Twelve bands, a long thin tail.

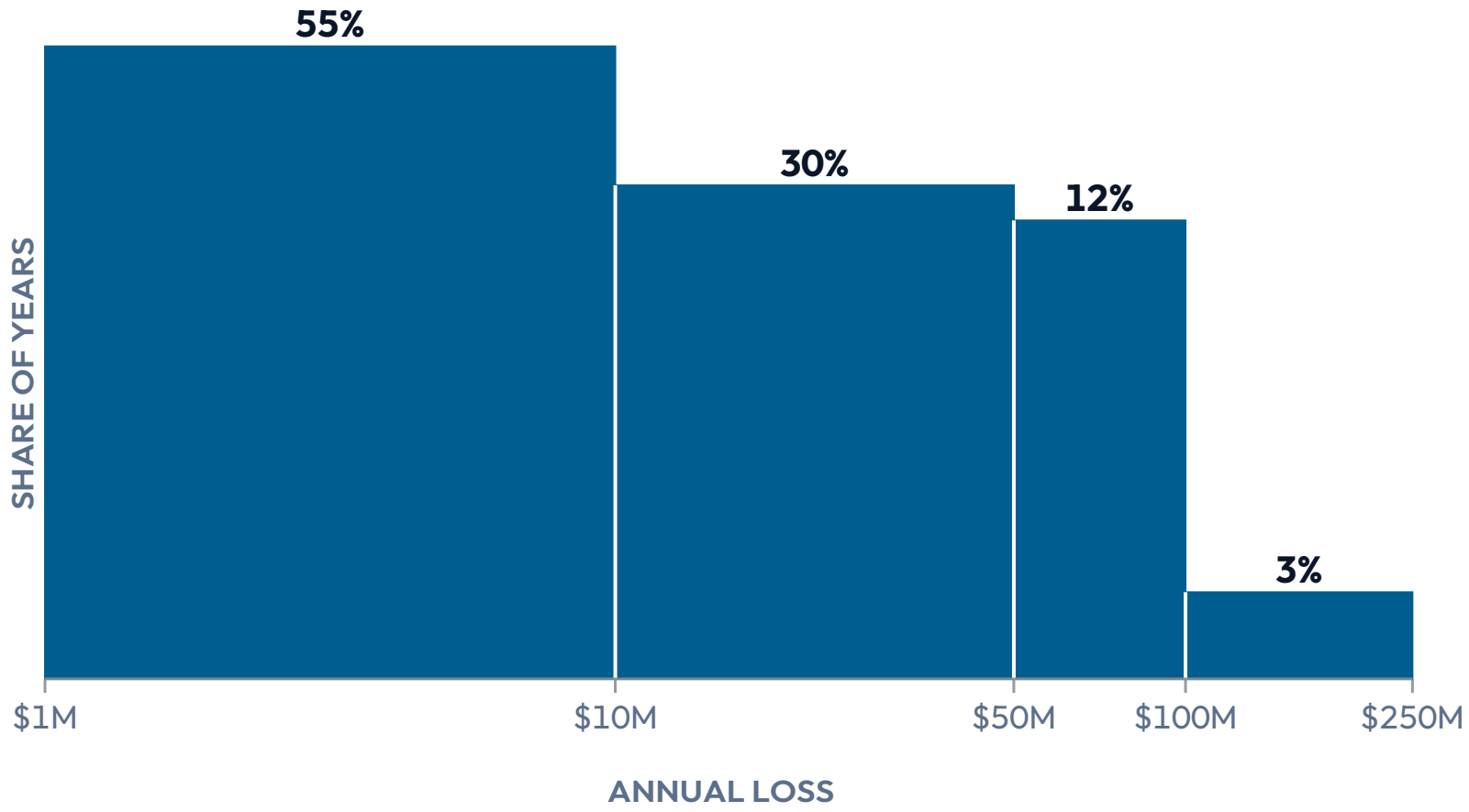


Stress test · histogram — Twelve equal bands on a linear axis, the tail bands under one percent.

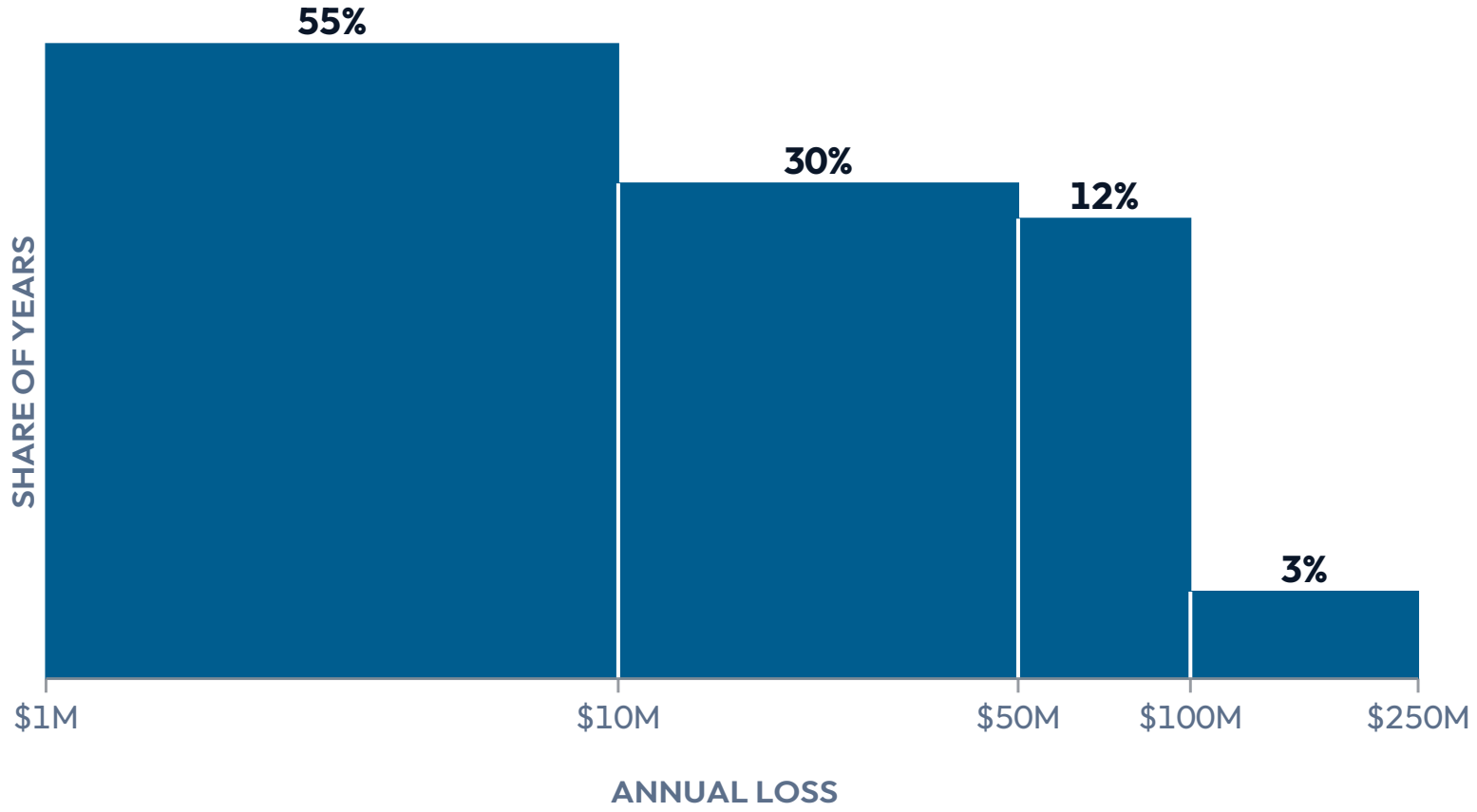
Most years stay under $10M; one in thirty tops $100M.



Most years stay under $10M; one in thirty tops $100M.



Most years stay under $10M; one in thirty tops $100M.



Composition: accent · histogram accent

When NOT to reach for histogram.

Categories that are not a number line

Regions, products or lines of business are separate things, not bands of one quantity. Use `bar`, which leaves gaps between them.

A dash for a range

`$1M-$10M` is not a band: the dash reads two ways beside a negative number. Write `$1M..$10M`.

Related components

See also.

`bar` — separate categories compared by size, not bands of one quantity

`ep-curve` — the chance of a loss above each amount, read as a return period

`line` — one quantity over time